

Chapter 109-1

Completing KPI.....

Liang Shi, who hadn't been in the workplace for a long time, was dazed for a second before she understood—it meant performance evaluation.

Xu Qingzhu was too smart.

She could deduce a logical thread purely from events that had already occurred, piecing together a clear logical line through guessing and deduction. Then she would probe and test, judging whether something was true based on the other person's expression.

Liang Shi, who was used to being honest, was truly no match for her.

But tonight's matter wasn't about completing a task for Liang Shi. She simply felt this scene was too beautiful and really wanted to hear Xu Qingzhu read poetry.

Her cool voice reading English poetry would definitely sound wonderful.

Moreover, when Liang Shi looked at her, she had already placed a hazy filter over her. But the moment she opened her mouth.....

Crack.

The filter shattered.

Instantly returning to reality, Liang Shi propped herself up on her arm, lying on her side, and said helplessly: "Xu Qingzhu, can you occasionally not overthink things?"

Xu Qingzhu raised an eyebrow at her, her smile carrying a hint of provocation. "For example?"

Liang Shi: "....."

She paused for a moment: "For example, just now I simply wanted to hear you read poetry."

"What about before?" Xu Qingzhu said. "Was it simple when you went to the escape room?"

Liang Shi: "....."

There was no way to play this game.

Xu Qingzhu continued: "May I ask, Miss Liang, was your invitation for me to go to the escape room also very simple? Was it your own subjective wish to invite me to such a pitch-black place, to embark on a dreamlike journey together?"

Liang Shi: "....."

At the mention of that escape room, Liang Shi's scalp still tingled.

She couldn't even think about it.

Yet Xu Qingzhu's words carried a hint of teasing, without the urgency of someone who absolutely needed to know the answer. She was just teasing Liang Shi.

You could tell from her mischievous gaze.

But Liang Shi happened to be someone who couldn't handle teasing—she couldn't withstand Xu Qingzhu's casual questions and those lightly-cast glances.

In that instant, Liang Shi felt as if she wasn't wearing any clothes.

Her entire being, inside and out, had been seen through by Xu Qingzhu.

With Xu Qingzhu's heat period approaching, her pheromones would faintly emanate from time to time. The room was permeated with the light scent of strawberry Baileys.

Liang Shi held her breath and didn't answer her question.

Xu Qingzhu, leaning against the headboard, slid down softly a bit, getting closer to Liang Shi—close enough to see her eyes especially clearly.

Liang Shi met her gaze, then guiltily looked away after a moment.

In the end, Liang Shi couldn't hold back and said quietly: "Teacher Xu, life is hard enough—don't expose people."¹

Xu Qingzhu laughed: "Really? I feel....."

"Your feeling is wrong." Liang Shi denied.

Xu Qingzhu let out a soft, questioning hum from her nose: "Is that so?"

When she asked "Is that so?" it was full of pressure, as if she was saying—you're lying to me.

Liang Shi closed her eyes briefly, trying to keep her tone relaxed. "Of course. I just wanted to hear you read poetry."

She met Xu Qingzhu's gaze again and even argued with her: "You asked me to sing, and I sang. So you reading me a poem isn't too much to ask, is it?"

As she said this, Liang Shi lacked confidence, her heart still pounding.

She was terrified that if Xu Qingzhu pushed any deeper, Liang Shi would directly reveal the existence of the system.

Even though the system said she couldn't possibly reveal the system to anyone, Xu Qingzhu would find other ways to get it out of her.

Liang Shi was dancing on the edge of danger.

Fortunately, Xu Qingzhu was only teasing her and didn't have any intention of absolutely needing to know. So after Liang Shi showed a hesitant look, she withdrew all her pressure and laughed lightly: "Of course it's not too much."

Xu Qingzhu's hair fell down onto the pillow. Liang Shi's idle hand had nothing to do, so she played with the ends of her hair.

The fine, soft strands seemed to come alive in an instant, winding around Liang Shi's fingers, round and round.

Xu Qingzhu watched Liang Shi and said with a light laugh: "Whatever Teacher Liang asks for is never too much."

These words were full of indulgence, yet they were spoken by Xu Qingzhu of all people.

Liang Shi felt she was being passive-aggressively mocked.

Her hand passed through Xu Qingzhu's fine, soft hair and lightly pinched her waist.

An Omega's body was especially sensitive near her heat period. Just being lightly touched made her let out a soft whimper.

It made one's heart tremble to hear.

Even knowing she shouldn't, it still made people have improper thoughts.

Wanting to make her cry out again.

Even if it meant losing her own soul in the process.

Liang Shi's hand, through her pajamas, reined itself in at the edge of danger. She let that thought remain just a thought without acting on it.

Her hand traced past Xu Qingzhu's fine, soft hair as she said quietly: "Don't tease me."

Xu Qingzhu couldn't help but laugh. "Why do you get annoyed so easily?"

Liang Shi looked at her.

Xu Qingzhu's eyes were bright and sparkling. When she smiled, her eyes curved, and those beautiful pupils reflected the light.

Liang Shi suddenly smiled along with her: "You should think about whether it's because you're too annoying when you speak."

Xu Qingzhu raised an eyebrow: "It's alright, I'm already restraining myself when facing Teacher Liang."

Liang Shi: "I feel like you only target me."

Xu Qingzhu: "....."

After a moment of being at a loss for words, Xu Qingzhu's gaze fell on the yellowed pages of the book. Her tone was languid and casual: "Anyway, isn't it enough that you're the special one?"

Her cool voice carried an indescribable meaning, as if she had taken a feather and was gently tickling Liang Shi's heart.

Liang Shi's hand, which had been playing with her hair, paused. But she still couldn't help herself—her hand fell on her waist again and gave it a light pinch.

Xu Qingzhu let out another soft hum.

Xu Qingzhu looked at Liang Shi's mischievous hand, then looked at Liang Shi. "Teacher Liang, you seem very active today."

Liang Shi pressed her lips together, her eyes blinking at her. "Really?"

Xu Qingzhu's hand suddenly spread open and came to rest in front of her eyelashes.

Liang Shi's eyelashes brushed against her palm.

Liang Shi said softly: "Because you said that Liang Shi can be herself."

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1. "人艱不拆" (rén jiān bù chāi) is a Chinese internet slang phrase, short for "人生已經如此艱難，有些事情就不要拆穿" meaning "Life is already so difficult, so don't expose certain things." It's used to ask someone not to point out or expose something awkward or embarrassing. ↩

Chapter 109-2

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Xu Qingzhu did end up reading poetry to Liang Shi. She recited it very properly, her emotions changing along with the content of the poems.

But every line that fell into Liang Shi's ears carried a lingering, tender meaning.

On a bed where they had just done certain things.

It really was hard not to let one's mind wander.

Even if it was just simply reading poetry.

There were many poems—some describing scenery, some expressing emotions—but for Liang Shi, what mattered wasn't the content of the poems, but the voice reading them.

She listened to Xu Qingzhu read poetry with her eyes half-closed, drowsiness gradually washing over her.

Under the dim yellow light, Xu Qingzhu's figure became increasingly hazy, as if seen through a layer of thick fog, impossibly beautiful.

When Xu Qingzhu saw that her breathing had become steady, she stopped reading, set down the poetry collection in her hands, placed the book on the nightstand, and dimmed the bedside lamp to its lowest setting. Then she lay down in the same position as Liang Shi.

Her arm was pressed under her head, propping it up slightly, while Liang Shi was tilted downward. Xu Qingzhu's other hand hovered in front of her eyes as she called out softly: "Jiejie."¹

This call of "Jiejie" was tender and gentle.

Her cool voice carried a unique texture. Her fingertips landed below Liang Shi's eyelids, lightly brushing across.

This movement made the sleeping Liang Shi stir slightly. Xu Qingzhu quickly withdrew her hand. Liang Shi, finding the position uncomfortable, shifted to lie flat on her back.

After a moment, she turned onto her side again. Her arm moved slightly, her fingers curled a little, and her mouth mumbled a single word.

Xu Qingzhu had good hearing and immediately made it out.

She had said: "Hug~"

Because she was asleep, the trailing sound was especially soft.

Xu Qingzhu lifted her blanket and obediently nestled into her embrace.

Liang Shi's hand naturally came to rest on her waist, as if by instinct. The moment it landed, her fingers lightly pinched her waist.

But because she was asleep, there was no strength behind it, so it turned into a gentle caress.

Yet her body's characteristics still made Xu Qingzhu let out an involuntary hum.

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Xu Qingzhu was so annoyed she wanted to bite her. But when her teeth touched Liang Shi's chin, she softened the pressure.

She merely rubbed against her skin like a cat, making Liang Shi feel ticklish. Liang Shi's palm came to rest on the top of her head, gently soothing her.

Xu Qingzhu immediately quieted down, her head pressed against Liang Shi's heart, slowly nuzzling against it like an obedient cat.

That place was as soft as Liang Shi's heart.

Xu Qingzhu lay contentedly against her heart.

To her, this was Jiejie.

The Jiejie she was willing to give everything for.

They had once run hand in hand without destination, had once watched fireflies dance under a pitch-black sky, had once embraced for warmth in a place with no light.

But her Jiejie had forgotten her.

It's okay, as long as she's by my side, Xu Qingzhu thought.

Those weren't good memories anyway, so forget them.

Xu Qingzhu closed her eyes and pressed close to her heart, listening to her steady heartbeat.

Xu Qingzhu held her tight and whispered: "Jiejie, it's enough that I remember you."

Everything you've forgotten, I will remember for you.

Those painful, unbearable, sorrowful memories of the past—don't ever recall them again.

I can accept you forgetting even me.

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1. "姐姐" (Jiejie) means "older sister" in Chinese. This is a term of endearment and respect. The context suggests Xu Qingzhu and Liang Shi (or rather, the original owner of Liang Shi's body) share a past that Liang Shi has forgotten, and Xu Qingzhu still calls her "Jiejie" from that time. ←

Chapter 109-3

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【Ding dong! Congratulations to the Host for completing Side Mission 2 (S-Rank): Spend 24 hours inseparable from Xu Qingzhu, including Mission Key Point 1: Go to an escape room with Xu Qingzhu, and Key Point 2: Sing to Xu Qingzhu to lull her to sleep.】

Just as Liang Shi was about to enter deep sleep, that familiar eerie mechanical voice sounded, making Liang Shi's head throb with pain.

Liang Shi really wanted to curse: You're truly wicked.

But she was too sleepy to have the energy to curse.

And the system continued in its usual style, chattering on endlessly.

【The reward for Side Mission 2 is 200,000 yuan, which will be deposited into the Host's account within ten minutes. Please check your balance.】

【After detection, the Host has completed all side missions for 90 luck points, and completed them very smoothly. What follows is the critical period for the Host to sprint toward 100 luck points. A reminder to the Host once again: you must trigger the key points to obtain 100 luck points. Host, keep it up! Work hard to complete the mission!】

【PS: I believe with the Host's abilities, you will definitely be able to complete this mission! Who knows, there might even be people who come knocking to help the Host complete the mission. After all, the Host is a 3S-rank lucky contestant.】

【Hmph! Last time Little Tong said you were a lucky salted fish,¹ and you weren't convinced! Are you convinced now? Every day someone helps you complete missions. Little Tong is really going to turn sour with jealousy like a lemon spirit!² But it's okay. The Host's mission deadline is approaching soon. Before you knew it, you've already been with Little Tong for over two months. Little Tong really can't bear to part with you. However... given that you still have additional missions after completing this one, Little Tong will continue to accompany you~】

The system's voice was irritating to hear. Liang Shi couldn't help but say coldly: "Get to the point."

System: 【.....】

After a moment, the system said: 【The point is, your indefinite mission will keep me by your side forever, so don't even think about getting rid of me~ Friendly reminder: The misfortune value system has quietly come online again, but Little Tong thinks that with the Host's current 98 luck points, the misfortune value system is pretty much useless now~】

This damn system now spoke with soft trailing tones, imitating human coquettishness in an awkward way that was simply torture for the listener.

Liang Shi had already tried her best to ignore its exaggerated tone and cheap coquettish act, but she still broke down in the middle of the night.

The reason for breaking down was naturally.....

"Can you remind me at a different time in the future? I was already asleep! Asleep!!" Liang Shi tried to let out a hoarse roar even in her mind to express her dissatisfaction.

But the system said: 【Sorry, Host. To prevent bugs from occurring again, we always choose to appear when the Host is about to rest, at a time when the capture target won't notice. If we disturbed your sleep, Little Tong bows to you in apology!】

System: 【Ying ying,³ will the Host really hate Little Tong because of this? Little Tong will be sad, you know.】

Liang Shi: 【.....】

If the system had a physical form, Liang Shi would definitely beat it up ten thousand times.

By now, Liang Shi was barely somewhat awake—only mentally awake; her body was still exhausted, and even lifting an arm was difficult.

She naturally also noticed that the system said her luck value had already accumulated to 98.

Very close to 100.

Recently, her luck value had been growing at a rapid pace.

However, the system's words also reminded her that her mission completion deadline was also approaching.

In other words, she had been here for almost three months.

These three months had passed so slowly.

Almost every day something happened, constantly being pushed forward by others.

But it was also fulfilling.

However, Liang Shi hoped that one lifetime of being this "fulfilled" was enough.

Having caught the system at just the right moment, Liang Shi asked while the system was still trying to chatter: "What's the deal with Sun Chengcheng? Did you deploy her here too?"

The system suddenly fell silent.

Liang Shi: "....."

She knew it was a useless system.

System: 【Host! Little Tong is thinking about how to tell you! How could Little Tong be useless?!】

Liang Shi: ".....Then go ahead and tell me."

After a long silence, just as Liang Shi was about to fall asleep again, the mechanical voice finally sounded: 【Sun Chengcheng was an accident that occurred when parallel worlds accidentally intersected and overlapped. Her obsession coalesced into a wish that also made her a member of the alternate dimension, shuttling between parallel worlds. Her storyline does not overlap with yours, but if you two cross paths, you'll have to resolve it yourselves.】

In short—it's none of my business; don't come to me about fighting.

But Liang Shi noticed one word—shuttling.

Liang Shi asked in a deep voice: "So she's been constantly traveling back and forth between two worlds?"

System: 【Sorry, Host. This question cannot be answered.】

Liang Shi: "....."

She really shouldn't have had too high expectations for this system.

But Liang Shi suddenly asked: "If my luck value reaches 100, will all traces of my existence in that world really be erased? There will no longer be a Liang Shi there, and no one will remember anything that happened to me there, right?"

System: 【Theoretically speaking, yes.】

But after a moment, the system added: 【If the Interstellar Court rules, and official detection confirms that the original owner has returned to normal, the possibility of deploying her back to her original world is not ruled out. However, she would not live as the identity you once lived as.】

In other words, ultimately all traces of her life there would be erased.

Liang Shi thought for a while but still didn't understand, so she asked again: "Why? Here, I have to take over her original world's storyline and continue living. Everything she did will be pinned on me. So why can't everything I accumulated there be given to her?"

System: 【.....Do you really want to give it to her?】

Liang Shi paused and discussed with it very seriously: "Whether I want to give it or not is secondary. The most important issue right now is that you haven't treated her and me equally. I have to bear the consequences of all the evil she did. Correspondingly, shouldn't she also receive everything I accumulated? If not, then why should her wrongdoings be pinned on me? Why can't you modify everyone's memories after my body comes over?"

The system fell silent once again.

And it was a long, eerie silence.

As if it didn't know how to respond.

This kind of human logic was something the system, as an AI, couldn't understand. It could only communicate according to the programs input by the administrators.

Once it encountered something it couldn't handle, it could only fall silent.

After a long while.

The system said: 【Because she no longer has blood ties there, but you still do. Modifying everyone's memories for you is a troublesome matter and carries risks, including but not limited to everyone forgetting you, changing your entire current network of relationships, and other issues. You can also choose this option; it's just that the consequences cannot be guaranteed.】

Liang Shi: "....."

What a truly irresponsible system.

System: 【Everything you obtained there was based on emotional needs—you received the emotional value you wanted. The original owner's previous needs have been satisfied, and her current needs are unknown. Even deploying her back to her original world would be dangerous, so it's only being considered on a case-by-case basis. But there's also a high possibility that she'll be placed into another world instead.】

Liang Shi: "....."

Ugh!

Liang Shi didn't want to communicate with this system anymore, and the system also hid itself at the right moment.

Having been disturbed by the system like this, much of Liang Shi's sleepiness had dissipated. When she came to, she saw Xu Qingzhu in her arms, quiet and well-behaved.

When asleep, she was like a clingy cat, her whole body draped over her.

Very warm.

Liang Shi couldn't help but smile. She rubbed her chin against her hair, held her tighter, and tried to share some of her own burning warmth with her.

In the end, she couldn't resist the drowsiness and fell asleep once more.

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1. "鹹魚" (xián yú, salted fish) is Chinese internet slang for someone who has no ambitions or motivation, like a dead fish that just lies there. A "lucky salted fish" implies someone who achieves things through luck without putting in effort. ⇐
 2. "檸檬精" (níng méng jīng, lemon spirit/lemon demon) is Chinese internet slang for someone who is extremely jealous or envious—because lemons are sour, it describes someone who has become "sour" with jealousy. ⇐
 3. "嚶嚶" (yīng yīng) is an onomatopoeia representing a cutesy whimpering or whining sound, often used in a coquettish manner online. ⇐

Chapter 109-4

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Liang Wanwan was part of the early class crowd and had developed social skills at school.

The next day, while Xu Qingzhu and Liang Shi were still asleep, she had already gone downstairs to buy breakfast.

She bought foods that couldn't go wrong—congee and baozi.¹

On this day, Haizhou City's temperature dropped again, at one point falling below zero. Yet when Liang Shi woke up, she felt warm beside her.

The moment she opened her eyes, the person in her arms also stirred, but only rolled over once and ended up lying face-down on the bed.

Liang Shi's arms were suddenly empty, and she felt the autumn cold wind hitting her. It was a bit cold now.

The person lying face-down on the bed struggled to move but couldn't.

She only stretched out her arm, her fingers continuously curling and spreading. Liang Shi's hand happened to be right beside hers, and she tried to gently reach over.

In an instant, their fingers hooked together.

After their fingers intertwined, Xu Qingzhu suddenly turned her head, looked at Liang Shi, and let out a soft laugh. Her voice carried the hoarseness of someone who had just woken up: "Morning."

Liang Shi: "Morning."

Seeing her so happy, Liang Shi couldn't help but ask: "Did you have a good dream?"

Xu Qingzhu nodded.

"What dream?" Liang Shi asked.

Xu Qingzhu's lips curved slightly, her voice containing a smile. "Not telling you."

Liang Shi: "....."

Her free hand stroked Xu Qingzhu's hair ends, and she said helplessly: "Fine."

When Xu Qingzhu and Liang Shi got up, they found breakfast on the table. Liang Wanwan was sitting on the sofa scrolling through her phone. Seeing them get up, she greeted them warmly: "Jie, Sister Qingzhu, good morning."

She had probably thought about that matter again at night and cried some more.

Liang Wanwan's eyes were badly swollen. Seeing this, Liang Shi said: "Did you cry again before bed?"

Liang Wanwan smiled embarrassedly. "I couldn't hold it in."

After a night of emotional adjustment, Liang Wanwan's mood had improved a lot, but she was still somewhat dejected.

Looking at her, Liang Shi was reminded of her former assistant Xiao Bai. When she had first become her assistant, she was also a particularly shy young girl who could shed tears over an injured cat on the roadside. She also had a habit of crying before bed, so everyone often saw her with swollen eyes the next morning.

Everyone would tease her for being a crybaby.

Seeing Liang Wanwan's appearance now, Liang Shi couldn't help but laugh: "You little crybaby."

As she spoke, she found a new towel, took some ice cubes from the refrigerator, wrapped them up, and handed them to Liang Wanwan. "Put this on your eyes. Look how swollen they've gotten."

Liang Wanwan took it and thanked her quietly.

Liang Shi didn't say anything more.

Xu Qingzhu, who was washing up at the sink, saw the interaction between the two. Especially upon hearing Liang Shi's somewhat indulgent "crybaby," her good mood from the morning suddenly vanished.

In Liang Shi's words, she was just a little bit unhappy.

Right, just a little bit.

However, Xu Qingzhu didn't show it. After finishing washing up, she noticed that Liang Wanwan was being very half-hearted about icing her eyes—one eye had the ice on it while the other eye was looking at her phone. Xu Qingzhu went over and said: "You need to ice both eyes, otherwise one will be swollen and one won't."

Liang Wanwan said: "Wait, I need to check in at Yang Shuyan's super topic."²

Xu Qingzhu paused. "You like Yang Shuyan?"

"Mm." Liang Wanwan said: "I like her red dress look."

"What a coincidence." Xu Qingzhu's eyes lit up. Before she could finish, Liang Wanwan cut in: "You too?"

Xu Qingzhu nodded.

Liang Wanwan said: "Her red dress look is really absolutely gorgeous. It's the photo that made me fall into the fandom."

Xu Qingzhu agreed: "Yes, I was also amazed by that movie of hers."

The two people who had both been captivated by the red dress look chatted animatedly here. Not only that, they also talked about that movie, discussing the characters in it at length.

Then they discovered that their understanding of the movie was very similar.

As they got into the conversation, Xu Qingzhu took out the complete set of signed photos that Yang Shuyan had given her and introduced them to Liang Wanwan like treasured possessions.

Seeing this, Liang Wanwan's mood—even accounting for the loss of Chen Mian's sketchbook last night—improved quite a bit.

Meanwhile, Liang Shi, who was washing up at the sink: "....."

She really wanted to ask: Is Yang Shuyan really that good-looking?

Xu Qingzhu was so happy just looking at that set of signed photos. If Liang Shi asked that, it would seem too petty.

Moreover, Liang Shi also wanted to say: No matter how good-looking Yang Shuyan is, she belongs to Zhao Ying!

But then she remembered that Xu Qingzhu also knew about this.

Liang Shi: "....."

Even a woman who already has a girlfriend—no, a friends-with-benefits—you're all this crazy about her.

If Yang Shuyan were truly single and available, they'd go absolutely insane!

First thing in the morning, Liang Shi felt like she had eaten a lemon.

No wait, the mint-flavored toothpaste was a bit sour.

It was the toothpaste's problem.

It had nothing to do with her.

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1. "包子" (bāozi) are Chinese steamed buns filled with meat or vegetables, a common breakfast food in China. ↵
 2. "超话" (chāo huà, super topic) is a fan community feature on Weibo (Chinese social media platform) dedicated to celebrities or topics. Fans can "check in" daily to show support and help boost their idol's rankings. ↵